

How a board is built

Six rules. Everything else in this guide is these six applied to 39 anchors and 23 shots across three boards.

1 One canvas per plate, not per scene

Every frame on a board inherits that board's key and palette. A board that mixes plates is a board where the light drifts between neighbouring shots. Movement I's coda returns to the Sun, so S23 is built on Canvas I even though it plays last.

2 Shelf first: plate, then location, then people and props

Drag each handle in from the Elements panel before generating anything. A face or a place that is dragged in cannot drift; one that is described in words will.

3 Anchors left to right in shot order

A

shared

frame ends one shot and starts the next — one image, generated once, serving two shots. A

bridge

is a near-black hidden cut. A

match

pair is two different images designed to cut together.

4 Batch of four, select one, and only then move on

The account holds one image per anchor. That is a skeleton, not a choice. Nothing downstream of a frame is generated until that frame is chosen.

5 Chain from the rendered last frame, never from the anchor still

Once a shot exists, pull its actual final frame and start the next shot from that. The anchor is the target; the render is the truth.

6 Any face at medium or closer is re-run on the Soul

Handles hold a look; Souls hold an identity. Generate with sou1_2 and that character's Soul whenever the face carries the shot.

Two things the API cannot do, so the canvas has to. It cannot place a generation inside the submission project — there is no folder call anywhere in the platform API — and it cannot pay for the final pass out of the credit balance. So the API is the concept side: it writes and holds the prompts, runs the wide batches that find a composition, and keeps the ledger. **Every frame and clip that reaches the cut is generated here, in the project.**

Do not route picture through anything else. Anything that touches the image outside the platform produces footage with no generation history behind it, which is what the rules exist to catch. Deflicker, upscale and grade inside Cinema Studio or not at all. Sound may be made anywhere — and then every audio file has to be uploaded into the project.

Scene 1, start to finish

Three anchors and two shots — the smallest complete unit in the film, and the only one whose every dependency is already chosen. Build this board first. If the method holds here it holds everywhere; if it does not, the fault is in the method and not in the film.

SHELF - DRAG THESE IN FIRST, LEFT TO RIGHT

@plate-sun

@courtyard-of-worlds

@oriane

@caedom-ascended-1

@frozen-tear

soul: oriane

soul: caedom-ascended

- 1 Open the project and show the Elements panel**
Everything is generated inside the submission project, from the first test frame onward. A frame made outside it has to be made again.
- 2 Drag the shelf in, in order**
@plate-sun first — it decides the key for every other tile on this board — then @courtyard-of-worlds, then @oriane and @caedom-ascended-1, then @frozen-tear.
- 3 Generate F01 — four variants, pick one**
Attach @plate-sun only. Judge it at thumbnail size: ninety percent of the frame must be empty black with one ember at the bottom edge. If you can see a horizon or a structure, it is wrong.
- 4 Generate F02 — four variants, pick one**
Attach @plate-sun and @courtyard-of-worlds. The centre has to be genuinely blinding: the seam that carries S1 into S2 hides inside that glare, and a readable centre means a visible cut.
- 5 Generate F03 — four variants, pick one**
Attach the plate, the location, both identities, **and the F02 you just chose** as the previous frame. Same room, same lens height, same costume state. Figures from behind — this is the last frame before the film shows a face.
- 6 Generate S1 from F01 → F02**
wan3_0 · 16s · 1080p · 21:9. Start frame F01, end frame F02. Slow vertical crane out of liquid flame; no horizon until the last third.
- 7 Extract S1's real last frame, then generate S2**
seedance_2_5 · video_extension forward · 18s. Do not start from the F02 still — start from the frame S1 actually rendered, or the join will show. End on F03.
- 8 Watch the two shots back as one 34-second run**
You are testing one thing only: whether the seam inside the glare is invisible. If it is not, the fix is a brighter F02, not a different S2.

Where Scene 1 stands right now. A four-variant selection pass for F01, F02 and F03 has been generated into the account and is waiting to be looked at. F03 was chained from the *skeleton* F02, so once you choose a real F02 it is worth re-running F03 against it — one batch, and the continuity is honest.

Canvas I · The Sun

Movement I and the coda. The only board that is a bright field — and so never the source for a social cut. **Look line:** Gold on black. Key from below, thrown by a burning star. Warm highlights, cold shadows, beams of solid light behaving as architecture.

SHELF — DRAG THESE IN FIRST, LEFT TO RIGHT

@plate-sun

@courtyard-of-worlds

@oriane

@caedom-ascended-1

@frozen-tear

soul: oriane

soul: caedom-ascended

The board — anchors across, shots bracketed underneath

F01

F02

F03

F04

F05

F06

F07

F08

F09

F36

F37

plate only @courtyard... @courtyard... @courtyard... @oriane @oriane @oriane @oriane, @... @frozen-te... @courtyard... @courtyard...

S1 · 16s
Rise out of the fire

S2 · 18s
The courtyard of worlds

S3 · 14s
“There must be risk”

S4 · 14s
“He’s your brother”

S5 · 18s
“Tomorrow” — the tear freezes

S23 · 12s
Tomorrow, again

shared — one image, two shots

bridge — hidden cut

match — designed together

no cut permitted inside

Frame ledger — write the job id you choose

FRAME	ROLE	ATTACH	WHAT IT HAS TO BE	CHOSEN JOB ID
F01	single	@plate-sun	Total black with the first suggestion of plasma at the bottom edge. The film's first frame...	
F02	shared	@plate-sun @courtyard-of-worlds	The courtyard of solidified light just resolving out of the star's glare, no figures yet. The...	
F03	single	@plate-sun @courtyard-of-worlds @oriane @caedom-ascended-1	Two figures from behind at the courtyard's far edge. Worlds on stems in the foreground, the...	
F04	single	@plate-sun @courtyard-of-worlds @oriane @caedom-ascended-1	Reverse two-shot, 40mm, both faces legible, star bokeh behind. This frame has to feel like a...	
F05	single	@plate-sun @oriane	Oriane turning her head. The motivated cut out; the movement is the edit point.	
F06	single	@plate-sun @oriane	Locked medium close-up, 75mm, lit from below, refraction crawling across the crystal...	
F07	single	@plate-sun @oriane	Identical framing fourteen seconds later. Wet eyes that have not spilled. Only the face has...	
F08	single	@plate-sun @oriane @caedom-ascended-1	Caedom's hands on her face. Tender, unhurried, both fully in frame.	
F09	match	@plate-sun @frozen-tear	Macro on the frozen tear, one facet filling frame, the interior a moving blue. Design this...	
F36	single	@plate-sun @courtyard-of-worlds @caedom-ascended-1	Caedom alone at the courtyard edge, standing where two people stood four minutes earlier.	
F37	single	@plate-sun @courtyard-of-worlds @frozen-tear	The frozen tear as one point of light on a vast luminous floor. Last frame of the film; it...	

Batch of four, select one

Every anchor in the account today is one generation — a skeleton, made so the boards could be laid out. None of them has been looked at. What follows is what to actually look at, by what kind of frame it is.

KIND OF FRAME	WHICH	WHAT DECIDES IT
Plate and location frames	F01, F02, F10, F23, F32	Judge at thumbnail size, squinting. You are checking key direction and where the bright shapes sit, not detail. Reject anything whose light disagrees with its plate.
Identity frames — a face at medium or closer	F06, F07, F35	Full size, and side by side with the character sheet. One moved feature is a rejection. Re-run on soul_2 with the Soul rather than arguing with a handle.
Shared frames	F02, F11, F12, F17, F30	Judged twice — once as the end of the shot before, once as the start of the shot after. A shared frame that only works one way is not chosen yet.
Match pairs	F09/F10, F22/F23	Only ever judged as a pair, laid side by side. Scale, colour and shape have to carry across the cut; either image alone tells you nothing.
Bridge frames	B01, B02	The test is whether they are dark or flat enough to hide a cut. If you can read detail in one, it is not a bridge.
Held shots — no cut permitted	S10, S13, S20	The composition has to survive being held for its whole duration. Look at it for the full sixteen seconds before choosing; boredom at second nine is a rejection.

Spend the allowance where the film is decided. F35 first — it is the last image in the film and it carries the whole ending. Then F06 and F07, the two-shot that has to hold fourteen seconds on one face. Then F17, the scale shot. Then the F09/F10 match, which is the only join between two movements. Everything else can be chosen in one pass.

Order of work

Gate A before any anchor is trusted: every reference on one screen, read left to right twice, looking for one thing — a face that moved. Then the anchors board by board. Then Gate B: all 39 on one contact sheet in film order. Drift caught at Gate B costs one image; the same drift caught after the motion pass costs a clip.

Canvas II • The Ocean

The whole of Movement II. Dark ground, high local contrast — every social cut comes from this board. **Look line:** Storm sea and sky near-black. Lightning, wave crests and hanging spray are the only bright shapes. Fully desaturated, no warm colour anywhere.

SHELF - DRAG THESE IN FIRST, LEFT TO RIGHT

@plate-ocean-dark

@oriane

@turned-water

@threadwright

@turned

@leviathan

@leviathan-plating

@oriane-ascended

@oriane-damaged

@aura-shell

@machira-orbit

@founding-stone

soul: oriane

The board — anchors across, shots bracketed underneath

F10

F11

F12

F13

F14

F15

F16

F17

B01

F18

F19

F20

F21

F22

plate on... @oriane @oriane,... @turned-... @threadw... @threadw... @leviath... @leviath... @leviath... @oriane-... @machira... @machira... @oriane-... @machira...

S6 · 14s
108 years later
— the run

S7 · 12s
Sixteen behind
her, and a wall
of ice

S8 · 14s
Up the wall

S9 · 12s
The
threadwright's
eyes

S10 · 16s
The leviathan

S11 · 10s
Running the
flank

S12 · 12s
The lightning
river

S13 · 15s
The vortex,
from the Sun

S14 · 13s
The Stone
leaves her

shared - one image, two shots

bridge - hidden cut

match - designed together

no cut permitted inside

Frame ledger — write the job id you choose

FRAME	ROLE	ATTACH	WHAT IT HAS TO BE	CHOSEN JOB ID
F10	match	@plate-ocean-dark	Open storm ocean at the exact scale, colour and shape of F09's facet...	
F11	shared	@plate-ocean-dark @oriane	Oriane running, camera locked beside her, the world streaked...	
F12	shared	@plate-ocean-dark @oriane @turned-water	Her body flat against the grey ice wall, hair spread, entirely unhurt...	
F13	single	@plate-ocean-dark @turned-water	The ice wall losing cohesion and collapsing into a mountain of seawater.	
F14	single	@plate-ocean-dark @threadwright	Over the threadwright's shoulder, quarry small and distant. No warmth...	
F15	single	@plate-ocean-dark @threadwright @turned	Her fingers mid-gesture, the marionettes in the middle distance...	
F16	single	@plate-ocean-dark @leviathan @leviathan-plating	The leviathan erupting, camera near the water looking up, dead coral...	
F17	shared	@plate-ocean-dark @leviathan @oriane-ascended	Oriane tiny between the opening jaws. Scale is the whole point of the...	
B01	bridge	@plate-ocean-dark @leviathan-plating	Bridge frame. The leviathan's flank filling frame to near-black. Must...	
F18	single	@plate-ocean-dark @oriane-damaged @aura-shell	She launches forward, lightning still circulating in the shell around...	
F19	single	@machira-orbit	Orbital, from the exosphere. The vortex eye open in the storm system...	
F20	single	@machira-orbit	The eye beginning to close. Still silent. Nothing in frame suggests...	
F21	single	@plate-ocean-dark @oriane-damaged	Oriane falling upward, crystal fracturing, the fractures filling with...	
F22	match	@machira-orbit @founding-stone	Empty sky, planetary curvature, the green streak crossing it. Paired...	

Canvas III · The Island

Movement III. Two plates on one board is the single exception to the one-plate rule, and it is why the bombardment shots are grouped. **Look line:** Golden hour with the treeline's shadow claiming most of the ground. The bombardment shots swap to plate-bombardment: low red sun, backlit, no cool tone.

SHELF - DRAG THESE IN FIRST, LEFT TO RIGHT

@plate-island

@nacre-beach

@alder

@wren

@corals-abyss

@plate-bombardment

@keepers-isle

@twelve-ships

@white-temple

@keeper-kneel

@keeper

@fx-floating-mountain

soul: alder

soul: wren

The board — anchors across, shots bracketed underneath

F23

F24

F25

F26

F27

F28

F29

B02

F30

F31

F32

F33

F34

F35

@nacre-b... @nacre-b... @corals-... @corals-... @plate-b... @plate-b... @plate-b... @plate-b... @plate-b... @plate-b... plate on... @white-t... @alder, ... @alder

S15 · 12s
Nacre Beach — the same sun

S16 · 12s
Over the abyss

S17 · 10s
Twelve ships

S18 · 10s
The Temple does not answer

S19 · 10s
The Keepers kneel

S20 · 14s
The mountain

S21 · 8s
The garden replants itself

S22 · 14s
What Alder saw

shared — one image, two shots

bridge — hidden cut

match — designed together

no cut permitted inside

Frame ledger — write the job id you choose

FRAME	ROLE	ATTACH	WHAT IT HAS TO BE	CHOSEN JOB ID
F23	match	@plate-island @nacre-beach	Nacre Beach at dawn, wide and static, with the streak's residue still...	
F24	single	@plate-island @nacre-beach @alder @wren	Two brothers stopped at the tide line, small in a very wide frame that...	
F25	single	@corals-abyss	Underwater reef in full colour, two silhouettes crossing the surface...	
F26	single	@corals-abyss	The shelf edge and the black past it. Never resolve what is down there...	
F27	single	@plate-bombardment @nacre-beach @alder @wren	The brothers staggering up the beach out of the surf, static wide, sun...	
F28	single	@plate-bombardment @keepers-isle @twelve-ships @alder @wren	Boys flat on the sand, twelve ships inside the same unmoving frame...	
F29	single	@plate-bombardment @white-temple @twelve-ships	The white temple taking direct hits, sand and torn flowers falling...	
B02	bridge	@plate-bombardment	Bridge frame. The dust wall — everything flattened to brown shadow, no...	
F30	shared	@plate-bombardment @keeper-kneel @keeper	Two lines of Keepers kneeling, heads bowed, metal shot still falling...	
F31	single	@plate-bombardment @fx-floating-mountain @keeper-kneel	The mountain's particles falling faster than gravity, ships going...	
F32	single	@plate-island	Flat open ocean. No wreckage, nothing left in the sky. Almost boring...	
F33	single	@plate-island @white-temple	Temple doors closing, the garden bed replanted, craters filled. Order...	
F34	single	@plate-island @alder @wren	Both brothers in the beach grass, Wren mid-sentence and delighted...	
F35	single	@plate-island @alder	Alder in close-up at the end of the push, a single dark cloud deep out...	

Four ways to order the same shots

Bar width is duration. Black is the Sun, grey the Ocean, pale the Island; hatched is a shot that does not exist yet. The question these four answer is whether Movement II's back half should fold into Movement III's front half.

A • Linear — three movements in order 0 new anchors



Nothing to build; chains run forward in strict order and the source's own sequence is preserved exactly. **But** it peaks at the vortex at 2:50 and then runs two minutes of falling action, and Oriane dies at 3:18 with two strangers arriving cold.

B • Prologue splice — the beach lands before she does 1 new anchor



Recommended. Splits S15 and moves the first half early, so the brothers are established before Oriane dies — the biggest structural complaint against the current cut, gone for one generation. F23 already carries the streak's reflection, so the only new frame is a clean Nacre Beach dawn with no streak in it. Risk: a quiet beach beat now sits immediately before the film's biggest moment.

C • Alternating — II's back half into III's front half about 3 anchors



Two clocks through the middle, and the scale jump into S13 gets bigger, not smaller. **But** alternation reads as simultaneity and the source explicitly denies it — and it strands three seams: F22/F23 no longer adjoin, S16 has to start off the closing vortex eye, and the green streak needs a new place to land.

D • Full causal interlace about 60 anchors



Argued properly and lost five criteria to three. It needs about 40 generations at a 7-second mean, asks the audience to infer a causal link the text denies, and ends on a resolution rather than a revelation — closing off the novel it exists to introduce.

Why B is cheap and C is not. The full interlace lost on source fidelity and on one-viewing legibility, and both losses come from the same thing: alternation reads as simultaneity, and the source opens the second story “the next day”. A single establishing beat placed early is not alternation. It buys the emotional continuity without asking anyone to infer a causal link the source denies.

Eight ways to lose a day

Each of these has already happened once on this production or is one obvious step away from it. They are cheap to avoid and expensive to discover late.

THE MISTAKE	WHY IT COSTS
Generating outside the project	Every asset in the film has to sit inside the submission project so the generation history verifies it. There is no folder call in the API — nothing can be moved in afterwards from code. Generate inside the project from the first frame.
Describing a face instead of dragging it	A described face drifts between frames and there is no fixing it later. Drag the handle; for anything at medium or closer, use the Soul.
Building on an unchosen frame	The account holds one image per anchor and none has been looked at. Anything chained off a skeleton frame has to be made again once the real frame is picked.
Starting a shot from the anchor still	The still is the target, not the output. Chain from the frame the previous shot actually rendered or the join will show.
Cutting inside a held shot	S10, S13 and S20 do their whole job by not cutting. Awe needs duration; a cut there destroys the only thing the shot is for.
Mixing plates on one board	Neighbouring frames inherit from whatever is nearest. One plate per board, with the bombardment shots as the one deliberate exception.
Naming a handle carelessly	The API cannot rename or delete an element. A wrong name is permanent from that side and has to be cleaned up by hand in the web app.
Leaving exploration in the project	Everything inside the project is read as part of the submission. Work the film does not use belongs outside it.

The order of everything

Gate A, identity — every reference on one screen, no face moved. Then the anchors, board by board, batch of four and select one. Gate B, the string — all 39 anchors on one contact sheet in film order. Gate C, timing — runtime, shot count and order frozen. Then the cheap motion pass, then Gate D. Then the final pass, then Gate E, picture lock, after which nothing is generated again. Sound, watermark, packshot, public post, and submit with a full day in hand.